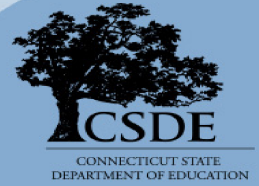


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



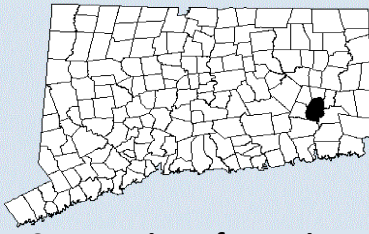
Norwich Free Academy District

Dr. Brian Kelly, Superintendent • 860-887-2505 • <http://www.nfaschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	9-12
Number of Schools/Programs	4
Enrollment	2,106
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	N/A
Total Expenditures ¹	N/A

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2022 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,106	52.5	48.4
Male	992	47.1	51.5
Non-Binary	8	0.4	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	39	1.9	0.3
Asian	160	7.6	5.2
Black or African American	226	10.7	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	563	26.7	30.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	7	0.3	0.1
Two or More Races	129	6.1	4.5
White	982	46.6	47.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	223	10.6	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,122	53.3	42.4
Students with Disabilities ³	273	13.0	17.1

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	355	32.4	188	15.8
Male	*	*	208	19.3
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	98	33.3	80	26.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	229	40.4	139	22.8
White	260	26.9	126	12.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	90	35.0	62	22.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	461	39.9	297	22.4
Students with Disabilities	116	47.3	75	24.8
District	669	31.9	396	17.4
State		20.0		7

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 421

Number of school-based arrests: 18

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Norwich Free Academy District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	140.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	10.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	20.7
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	11.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	7.5
School Level	12.3
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	2.0
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	24.6
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	103.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.5	0.1
Asian	6	2.9	1.3
Black or African American	10	4.8	4.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	6.3	4.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	177	85.5	88.7

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	12.2	13.2

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	65	97.0	72	92.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	121	89.6	115	89.8
White	227	96.2	270	96.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	56	88.9	39	70.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	245	95.0	267	92.7
Students with Disabilities	60	100.0	53	89.8
District	473	95.0	508	93.9
State		86.5		94.2

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		68.6

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Norwich Free Academy District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.4
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.0
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.3
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.4
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	16.7

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.1
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.7

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2021-22

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	N/A	N/A	\$12,671
Support services - students	N/A	N/A	\$1,558
Support services - instruction	N/A	N/A	\$837
Support services - general administration	N/A	N/A	\$463
Support services - school based administration	N/A	N/A	\$1,133
Central and other support services	N/A	N/A	\$716
Operation and maintenance of plant	N/A	N/A	\$1,893
Student transportation services	N/A	N/A	\$1,464
Food services	N/A	N/A	\$5
Enterprise operations	N/A	N/A	\$186
Total	N/A	N/A	\$20,165

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	N/A	N/A	29.0
Instructional Aide Salaries	N/A	N/A	10.6
Other Salaries	N/A	N/A	10.1
Employee Benefits	N/A	N/A	13.1
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	N/A	N/A	5.9
Special Education Tuition	N/A	N/A	21.8
Supplies	N/A	N/A	0.7
Property Services	N/A	N/A	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	N/A	N/A	8.1
Equipment	N/A	N/A	0.2
All Other Expenditures	N/A	N/A	0.1
Total	N/A	N/A	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		N/A	24.9

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2021-22

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	N/A
State	N/A
Federal	N/A
Tuition & Other	N/A

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Norwich Free Academy District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	28	57.9	28	62.5	28	66.1
Black or African American	57	38.7	57	37.6	58	40.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	106	40.4	106	39.0	111	42.5
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	22	46.6	22	42.4	20	52.4
White	226	52.7	226	48.9	221	58.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	58	33.6	58	34.9	60	36.7
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	392	50.1	392	47.1	389	54.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	207	43.0	207	40.7	207	46.3
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	243	52.2	243	49.6	242	57.6
Students with Disabilities	50	31.8	50	28.6	50	28.7
Students without Disabilities	400	50.0	400	47.6	399	55.3
High Needs	235	41.7	235	39.7	237	44.6
Non-High Needs	215	54.7	215	51.9	212	61.1
District	450	47.9	450	45.5	449	52.3

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	N/A	N/A	64.8	528	64.8
Curl Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	74.3	525	74.3
Push Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	62.2	518	62.2
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	N/A	N/A	33.7	501	33.7
All Tests - District	N/A	N/A	N/A	23.7	494	23.7
All Tests - State	51.5	46.0	44.1	41.1		45.5

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Norwich Free Academy District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2021-22	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	97	84.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	100	79.0
White	267	91.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	59	78.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	311	83.9
Students with Disabilities	74	73.0
District	524	88.5
State		88.9

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2021-22 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	97.1	203	36.9
Male	*	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*	*
Black or African American	95.2	22	15.2
Hispanic or Latino	93.5	44	16.7
White	96.7	232	44.9
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	89.0	8	6.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	95.6	124	22.7
Students with Disabilities	83.2	*	*
District	96.1	360	34.6
State	95.2		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2023 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2022	Class of 2021
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	66.5	80.6
Male	56.8	81.7
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	61.0	70.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	42.7	72.7
White	66.5	85.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	33.3	76.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	49.6	73.3
Students with Disabilities	27.8	*
District	61.5	81.0
State	66.1	87.7

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Norwich Free Academy District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	47.9	75	95.9	150	63.9	63.9
	High Needs Students	41.7	75	83.5	150	55.7	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	45.5	75	91.0	150	60.7	59.7
	High Needs Students	39.7	75	79.4	150	52.9	48.9
Science Performance Index	All Students	52.3	75	69.8	100	69.8	61.6
	High Needs Students	44.6	75	59.4	100	59.4	51.1
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	57.2%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	52.5%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	61.8%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	55.5%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	31.6%	100%	15.8	50	31.6	55.3%
	Oral	48.2%	100%	24.1	50	48.2	56.1%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	31.9%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	20.0%
	High Needs Students	40.1%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	28.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	94.4%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	90.4%
	% Meeting Benchmark	34.6%	75%	23.1	50	46.2	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		74.2%	94%	39.5	50	78.9	82.4%
4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)		88.5%	94%	94.2	100	94.2	88.9%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)		85.9%	94%	91.4	100	91.4	85.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)		61.5%	75%	82.0	100	82.0	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		89.0% 23.7%	75%	7.9	50	15.8	93.0% 45.5%
Arts Access		60.9%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	54.5%
Accountability Index				957.0	1550	61.7	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	54.7	41.7	13.0	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	51.9	39.7	12.2	18.0	
Science Performance Index Gap	61.1	44.6	16.5	17.8	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	85.9%	8.1%	8.7%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	95.4
	High Needs Students	92.5
Math	All Students	95.4
	High Needs Students	92.5
Science	All Students	95.0
	High Needs Students	92.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A

State: 49.6

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Norwich Free Academy District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

We started the school year by developing a Theory of Action that supported the principles: Relationships Matter, Empower All, and Life-Prepared. Then, we engaged in a comprehensive self-study for NEASC. At the end of the year, the faculty identified the following focus areas for our learning plans in the 2023/24 school year: improved communication, collaboration and curriculum. We also developed a shared understanding of high-quality instruction and our Portrait of a Graduate. We specifically sought parent/guardian feedback with the NEASC self-study and the Portrait of a Graduate work.

The week before school began we hosted a 9th grade welcome event to bring our newest students and their families to campus. This was an opportunity for students and families to meet the 9th grade teachers and other students, visit classrooms, tour the campus and learn about other aspects of campus life. In a grades 9-12 district that welcomes students from at least 9 partner districts, we thought this was a necessary step for a smooth transition.

The Student Services Department created two additional positions to improve our special education program. A supervisor was hired to oversee the PPT process and to provide our student services staff with targeted training on developing and implementing IEPs. In addition, a department head position was created to work directly with the special education teachers in providing instructional feedback and supporting professional learning both individually and as a department.

The grade-level support teams conducted student attendance conferences with students who were chronically absent, and when possible, their caregivers to discuss attendance related barriers and to create plans to remedy these barriers. In these plans there may be referral to counseling or other services to assist in helping students to attend school regularly or daily morning check ins with a school counselor or social worker. Copies of these plans are given/sent home to the caregiver and placed in the student's file. NFA continued to partner with community agencies, such as Norwich Youth and Family Services, the Department of Children and Families and Norwich Police Department, to address barriers related to school attendance. We also helped to address student truancy response and prevention through our in-house Attendance Review Board. The NFA Foundation offered assistance to support school-attendance related barriers for students with housing instability.

Our school counseling department held their first "Coffee with Counselors" event to engage parents in visiting campus during the school day to meet the school counselors. The department also started a School Counseling Advisory board that met 4 evenings during the year and included parents and teachers.

The Diversity department collaborates with community groups such as NAACP, Global Cities Norwich and the Greenville Neighborhood committee. This provides a strong relationship with the Norwich community. Students and community members participated in numerous activities through Norwich Race Equity collaboration: Race Equity in the Arts, Race Equity in STEM and Race Health Disparities.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Because our Integrated Math classes tended to have an overrepresentation of students of color, which limited their access to advanced mathematics classes, we eliminated this course in 9th grade. Now students begin with at least an Algebra 1 class. In order to ensure all students had access to an electronic device to use at school, we created a Chromebook loan program for any student in need.

The Language Intervention Specialists also provide translation services for any office or family needing translation assistance.

The Wildcat Loft allows all students free access to clothing, hygiene products and school supplies regardless of need. At least 1660 transactions were conducted this school year. Similarly, the NFA Food Pantry exists to combat food insecurity for any NFA student. Food bags were sent home with approximately 50 students each week. The United Way collaborates with us in assessing community need.

Students in our social studies classes had an opportunity to visit the Amistad ship when it was docked in the Norwich harbor. In addition, a number of our multilingual students attended a Cape Verdean workshop at Mystic Seaport. NFA's Native American Student Group sponsored a Native American Showcase in November where students learned about traditional dress, dance and music. Over 500 students from various classes attended a Black History Month presentation called Rhapsody in Black, which focused on racism in America.

Over 100 students participate in the following clubs focused on language and culture: Haitian Club, Cape Verdean Club, Successful Latino Alliance, Native American Group, Asian Culture Club, NAACP Youth Council, Muslim Club. Students of any background are invited and encouraged to join. In addition, we recognize and participate in the following cultural events either at NFA or in the Norwich Community: Haitian Flag Day, Hispanic Heritage Month, Cape Verdean Festival, Juneteenth Day, Martin Luther King Luncheon and March, Black History Month, NAACP Freedom Fund Dinner.

Approximately 20 students applied for the Martin Luther King trust fund scholarships. Thirty students from diverse backgrounds have or will be taking part in internships sponsored by Dime Bank, CorePlus Credit Union, City of Norwich and Mystic Aquarium.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Norwich Free Academy District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

NFA is a comprehensive independent high school that has a Master Educational Agreement with the Boards of Education from eight local Partner Communities. To that end, NFA is regarded as a single school district (one high school) that serves students from approximately twenty-one CT communities.